

Mid term Question bank

The poet Mushafi (c. 1750-1824) declared around 1785, that the mode of the day was:

- a) Persian verse
- b) Arabic prose
- c) Hindvi verse
- d) Sanskrit epic

2. The term “Urdu” as a name for the language first appears in the works of:

- a) Amir Khusrau (1253-1325)
- b) Mir Asaf Khan (1748-1806)
- c) Mushafi (c. 1750-1824)
- d) Shah Alam II (1728-1806; r. 1759-1806)

3. Initially, the term *zabān-e urdu-e mu’alla* signified:

- a) The language of the military camp
- b) The language of the common people
- c) The Persian language
- d) A mixed dialect of South India

4. The name “Urdu” for the city of Delhi is clearly used in the work of:

- a) John Gilchrist (1759-1841)
- b) Sirāj ud-Dīn ‘Alī Khān-e Ārzū (1679-1756)
- c) Edward Terry (1590-1660)
- d) Bharatendu Harishchandra (1850-1885)

5. Which Mughal emperor’s informal use and patronage of Hindi gave the language new respectability in Delhi?

- a) Akbar (1542-1605; r. 1556-1605)
- b) Shah Jahan (1592-1666; r. 1628-1658)
- c) Aurangzeb (1618-1707; 1658-1707)
- d) Shah Alam II (1728-1806; r. 1759-1806)

6. John Gilchrist (1759-1841) argued that “Hinduwee” was:

- a) The exclusive property of the Hindus alone.
- b) A language created by Muslim invaders.
- c) A superior form of Hindustani.
- d) Best written in the Roman script.

7. The story that Urdu was born in Muslim army camps was popularized by:

- a) The writings of Khān-e Ārzū (1679-1756)
- b) Mir Asaf Khan’s (1748-1806) *Bāgh o bahār*
- c) The poetry of Ghalib (1797-1869)
- d) British military manuals

8. The poet and physician Aḥad ‘Alī Khān Yaktā attributed the development of Urdu to:

- a) The need for a military lingua franca.

b) The mixing of languages at the royal court and through intercultural exchange.

c) A decree from Emperor Akbar.

d) The influence of Sufi saints alone. *Student name:* _____

Date: _____

9. Bharatendu Harishchandra, a key figure in modern Hindi, began his literary career in:

a) Sanskrit

b) Braj Bhasha

c) Urdu

d) Bengali

10. Muhammad Husain Āzād's (1830-1910) history of Urdu poetry, *Āb-e hayāt*, is criticized

for:

a) Being too long and detailed.

b) Ignoring major Hindu poets of the 18th century.

c) Promoting the use of the Nagari script.

d) Focusing only on secular poetry.

(1) Everyone has a mother tongue.

a. True

b. False

(2) Each language is a

a. unity

b. plurality

(3) Meaning is

a. open

b. closed

(4) The word for ethnicity in Urdu is _____.

- (5) There is no ‘ethnically’ _____ territorial space on Earth.
- (6) The lecture argued that the modern enthusiasm for ‘genealogy’ is related to the modern obsession with _____.
- (7) The lecture related modern *mononology* to the movement for modern ‘scientific’ nomenclature, whose ‘founding father’ was _____.
- (8) What are two other names for the language we call ‘Urdu’?
- a. _____
- b. _____
- (9) The word ‘dialect’ means _____.
- (10) Bonus question: What is the ‘Weinreich witticism’?

11. The authors of *Hobson-Jobson* incorrectly claimed the word *urdu* came to India with

_____.
12. In the 1750s, among the elite, the term *zabān-e urdu-e mu’alla* did **not** refer to the language known today as _____.

13. Gilchrist claimed that in Persian, the word *hindi* means _____, which Faruqi calls a canard.

14. As late as 1858, the poet _____ was uncomfortable using “Urdu” as a language name.

15. Aḥad ‘Alī Khān Yaktā stated that the standard *register* of speech was to be found among the inhabitants of _____.

16. The poet Amir Khusrau (1253-1325) stated that he had three *divāns*, in Arabic, Persian, and _____.

17. The meaning of mononomological is:

18. What are two of the names of God that Shah Fazl-e-Rahman Ganj Muradabadi (1794-1895) uses in his translation of the Surah-e-Fateha?

a.

b.

19. The expression you have learned in this course to conceptualize the construction of large historical collectivities in modern historical consciousness is:

Collective-_____ historical _____.

20. At the beginning of the brief recording, by what name does the poet Jaun Elia (1931-

2002) say the poet Mir Taqi Mir (1723-1810) would have called the language we today call 'Urdu'? _____

Richard Eaton argues (in *India in the Persianate Age*) that the construction of monumental

temples by kings had both an advantage and a disadvantage. What are they?

Advantage: _____

Disadvantage: _____

(2) Gujarat's famous Somnath temple was fortified by locals to protect it from attacks by

Mahmud of Ghazni.

a. True

b. False

(3) The two large scale processes highlighted by last week's lecture under the title, 'Key

Developments in the Delhi Sultanate and Mughal Periods' were:

a.

b.

(4) Name at least three major Sufi orders in South Asia – including the largest one:

a.

b.

c.

- (11) What are the three elements of the Orientalist 'triptych' of Indian history as outlined by the historian David Arnold
- a. _____
 - b. _____
 - c. _____
- (12) What are the two interrelated misperception about India's past?
- One, that classical text of brahmans represent

- Second, India was timeless meaning

- (13) The period of the Delhi Sultanate was characterized by (circle all that apply):
- a. expansion of the agricultural frontier
 - b. extension of commercial networks
 - c. gradual technological change
 - d. mass conversions to Islam
 - e. development of political and religious institutions
 - f. creative cultural expression in local, vernacular contexts
- (14) There is marked discontinuity between the Delhi sultanate and earlier Indian regimes.
- a. True
 - b. False
- (15) The first Turkic dynasty in Delhi was established by the Mamluk or Slave ruler _____ in 1206.
- (16) Non-Muslims were governed by the *sharia* under the Delhi sultanate.
- a. True
 - b. False
- (17) India's Muslim populations are primarily to be found in the core areas of Muslim rule.
- a. True
 - b. False

- (18) “He who is immersed in His love day and night sees Him immanent in the three worlds, and throughout all time. He becomes like Him whom he knows. He becomes wholly pure, his body is sanctified, and God dwells in his heart as his only love.”

This passage is by which devotional reformer: _____.

- (19) What was the unifying ideology for the multi-ethnic, multi-religious polity of Mughal empire?

- (a) Loyalty to Hindustan
- (b) Loyalty to the emperor
- (c) Loyalty to the language of the court
- (d) Loyalty to the religion of the emperor

- (20) Analyzing the decline following Aurangzeb’s rule, Metcalf and Metcalf hold that a singular focus on the personality and policies of one ruler is not only inadequate but also fits easily into the old European theory of

- (a) Asiatic Glory
- (b) Asiatic despotism
- (c) Orientalism
- (d) Enlightenment

- (21) Akbar’s invited to his new court at Fatehpur Sikri for _____
Brahmans, yogis, Jains, Jesuit priests who travelled up from Portuguese trading enclaves on the south-west coasts, Zoroastrians, and Muslim scholars of every orientation.

- (22) Dara Shikoh was a liberal leader, and Aurangzeb was the religious conservative who helped undo pluralism of the Mughal empire and contributed to its downfall. Is this statement True or False, in light of Metcalf’s analysis? Explain why? (2)

- (23) Aurangzeb despite his outwardly Islamic posture, depended on _____ in his court for rule.

- (24) In his passion to bring Deccan into his rule, Aurangzeb fought with _____ and _____ (Name at least two entities)

(25) The Naqshbandi Sufi Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi (1564–1624), who is a reminder to the fact that subcontinent itself has been a centre of Islamic thought and practice criticized _____ policies of Akbar and his succeeding emperor. He was imprisoned by _____ on account of self-aggrandizement.

(26) Metcalf maintains that new scholarship also proposes to call the period of Mughal rule as the early modern period in India, instead of Medieval or Muslim era, for what reasons? (2)

(27) Enlist three reasons why the period of Mughal rule cannot be designated as ‘foreign?’ (2)

QUIZ WEEK 5

1) What does the term *Shahinshah* signify about the political fabric of the Indian region during the period of the Taimurid (Mughal) Empire, contrasted with the political structure of a modern state? (1.5)

- 2) Who was Bhimsen Saxena? Summarize his remarks about the period of the Emperor Aurangzeb as he highlighted the failures and the challenges of the King's ways. (1.5)

- 3) Name the three 'fault lines' in the Mughal empire's rule, and explain how these challenged the Empires hold? Provide at least one example of such challenging entities with their specific name. (3)

A)

B)

C)

- 4) Give one strong reason with example to establish that the modern conceptions of Shivaji's fights against Aurangzeb were a power struggle rather than a religious/ethnic conflict. (1.5)

- 5) In 1739, the armies of the Persian king _____, wrought havoc along his route and looted the city of _____, killing some _____ people, giving a blow to already weakened Mughal Empire. Amongst the looted prizes he took home was Shah Jahan's _____(bonus). (1.5)

- 6) What was the view of eighteenth-century India, apart from Delhi? (Guess: Delhi was in chaos given the incursion from Afghan rulers and challenges from Maratha and Sikhs rulers)

PAMSA S7

Quiz

22 October 2024

1. What was Warren Hastings understanding about the India's own laws, customs and traditions as he believed that Indians should be rule according to that 'body of law'? where were this 'body of law' to be found? (2)

2. Hastings established the system of _____ whose tasks included along with collection of taxes but expanded further as magistrates to manage the police and even as judges decide at courts. They had limited local authority.
3. Lord Wellesley founded the College of Fort William at _____ in 1802 as a place where incoming _____ were provided with a two year training and taught local languages prior to taking up their appointments.
4. In 1784, Hastings also established the Asiatic society for Bengal under the leadership of Sir _____, the purpose of which was to _____.
5. In the later decades, the british sought to base their understanding of their colonial subject through 'scientific' means for which the great _____ survey began in 1818.
 - a. Geometrical
 - b. Numerical
 - c. Trigonometrical
 - d. Geographical
6. During the late eighteenth century nabobs (British high officials) and common soldiers alike customarily lived openly with Indian mistresses called _____, which was made impossible after the introduction of the _____.

(2)

7. What is the phenomenon of Military Fiscalism, which according to author led to the demise of many princely states at the hands of the EIC? (2)

8. In which year the Marathas were final defeated at the hands of British?

a. 1815 b. 1818 c. 1820 d. 1822

9. What was the system of indirect rule created by the EIC? (2)

10. Describe features of the Indian colonial economy during the Company Raj, hence explain the role of opium trade in the British fortune building trade enterprise. (3)

11. The disastrous effects of colonial imposition of 'property rights' to the agrarian system of Bengal and the new revenue system, both as part of Warring's management of Bengal's agriculture resulted in the deadly Bengal famine in _____.

- a. 1770 b. 1777 b. 1787 d. 1775

12. How did the British classify the nomad/indigenous tribes of India, like the Banjaras, in their fictional imaginatiions to justify them as the 'criminal tribes?'

- a. Looters b. Barbarians c. Thugees d.
Savages

13. Ram Mohan Roy, the earliest Brahman reformer (after EIC takeover of Bengal), who sought to reform and improve Hindu faith with modern and enlightened principles, established _____ in 1828.

- a. Arya Samaj b. Sanatan Dharma c. Brahmo Samaj d.
Brahmo Dharam

14. As part of reforming the native Hindus, which practice was banned by the British Governor-General Lord Bentick? _____

15. _____ wrote his 'Minutes on Education' in 1835 in which he maintained that all the books from India and Arabia combined were not even worth a single shelf of European library.

- a. Lord Minto
- b. Lord Macaulay
- c. Lord Bentick
- d. Lord Cornwallis